Session 2: Register & Clarity Rewrite Studio

Name:
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Part A: One Message, Three Audiences

Core message: The report will be two days late because we found errors in the data.

Peer version

Heads up: the report is going to slip by two days. We spotted some errors in the data and I'd rather fix them than send it as it is. Could you help me recheck the tables tomorrow?

Annotations

- Register: informal and spoken, with phrases like "heads up" and "slip".
- Contractions and "I" keep it friendly and quick to read.
- It ends with a specific request, because a peer can share the work.
- No apology is needed; a peer wants information, not formality.

Manager version

The report will be delivered two days later than planned. During our review we found errors in the data, and I want to correct them before submission. I will share a revised delivery date by tomorrow noon. Please let me know if this delay affects any other deadline.

Annotations

- Register: professional and direct, with the bottom line in the first sentence.
- It gives the cause, the fix and a time commitment, which a manager needs in order to decide.
- No contractions; "by tomorrow noon" is a precise promise.
- The closing line invites the manager to flag impact instead of asking for help.

Client version

Thank you for your patience. To make sure the figures you receive are accurate, we are rechecking part of the data, so the report will reach you two days later than planned. We will confirm the new delivery date by tomorrow. We apologise for the inconvenience.

Annotations

- Register: formal and courteous, opening with thanks.
- The reason is stated honestly but framed around what the client gains: accurate figures.
- Internal detail is left out; the client needs the new timing, not the working process.
- It includes an explicit apology and a clear next step.

Part B: Three Ambiguous Sentences, Rewritten

Ambiguous sentence	Two possible meanings	Clear rewrite	Rule and why it works
The manager told the intern he was wrong.	"He" is the manager (he admitted a mistake) or the intern (the intern made the mistake).	The manager told the intern, "Your figures are wrong."	A pronoun needs one clear noun to point to. With two same-gender nouns, I repeat the noun or use a direct quote.

Ambiguous sentence	Two possible meanings	Clear rewrite	Rule and why it works
We reviewed the report on the new system.	The report is about the new system, or we used the new system to review the report.	We reviewed the report about the new system.	"On" is too loose. A more specific preposition such as "about" or "using" shows how the phrase connects.
Old clients and partners were invited.	"Old" describes only the clients, or both the clients and the partners.	Long-standing clients and all of our partners were invited.	An adjective before joined nouns may cover both. I repeat it or restructure so its reach is obvious.